

4066. Maximum Equal Adjacent Pairs After at Most One Replacement

Solved ●

Medium  Topics 

You are given a **1-indexed** integer array `nums`.

You can choose two **distinct** values `x` and `y` and perform the following operation **at most** once:

- Replace every occurrence of `x` in `nums` with `y`.

Return the **maximum** possible number of pairs of adjacent elements that are equal after performing the operation.

Example 1:

Input: `nums = [1,2,3,2]`

Output: 2

Explanation:

- One optimal solution is to choose `x = 3` and `y = 2`.
- The resulting array is `[1, 2, 2, 2]`.
- There are 2 pairs of adjacent elements that are equal: `(nums[2], nums[3])` and `(nums[3], nums[4])`.
- Therefore, the answer is 2.

Example 2:

Input: `nums = [1,2,1,2,1]`

Output: 4

Explanation:

- One optimal solution is to choose `x = 1` and `y = 2`.
- The resulting array is `[2, 2, 2, 2, 2]`.
- There are 4 pairs of adjacent elements that are equal: `(nums[1], nums[2])`, `(nums[2], nums[3])`, `(nums[3], nums[4])`, and `(nums[4], nums[5])`.
- Therefore, the answer is 4.

Example 3:

Input: `nums = [1,1,1]`

Output: 2

Explanation:

- One optimal solution is to perform no operation.
- Thus, the resulting array is `[1, 1, 1]`.
- There are 2 pairs of adjacent elements that are equal: `(nums[1], nums[2])` and `(nums[2], nums[3])`.
- Therefore, the answer is 2.

Constraints:

- `2 <= nums.length <= 105`
- `1 <= nums[i] <= 109`

Seen this question in a real interview before? 1/6

Yes No

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-  Topics 
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-  Discussion (25) 